Worthing Brighton Bus

Passengers deserve one network. This one is built from open data.

On this coast, four bus companies run four apps and their own day tickets, and two councils plan up to a line through Portslade. This proof of concept joins it all up from the government's open bus data, and measures how the buses really run.

Try it live:
worthingbrightonbus.co.uk

Step 1 of 8 · Published timetable, week of 19 October 2026

What passengers face today

Four operators each run their own apps and tickets. With a council boundary through the community, services in the west are weaker on every measure.

- Weekday departures per stop: 64.9 west of the line against 99.7 east, in a band 4 km either side (65%).
- Routes on a weekday: 20 against 39. On Saturday 11 against 26; on Sunday 9 against 23.
- Departures after 11pm on a weekday: 587 west of the line against 1,377 east.
- Lancing and South Portslade, about five miles apart on the same coast road: 32.8 against 121.7 weekday departures per stop.
- Joint working pays: up to 43% more passengers on the two routes the councils improved together. The coast west of Portslade wasn't one of them.

Sources: Brighton & Hove Bus Service Improvement Plan, 2025 refresh (joint scheme with West Sussex on routes 17 and 273, PDF page 22); The generated boundary evidence.

Step 2 of 8 · Live

The network as people use it

Each operator's buses on one map and one departure board. Every operator's ticket zones in one place, and a cross-operator journey checker.

- Four companies on one departure board: at St Peter's Church in Brighton, Brighton & Hove, Metrobus, Stagecoach and Compass departures are listed together, with live times marked.
- Every operator's day-ticket zones on one map, and a checker that finds the cheapest ticket that covers a whole journey, across companies.
- Door-to-door planning across operators, still experimental.

Step 3 of 8 · Recorded: 32 days, 16 September to 17 October

What the buses actually did

The same open feed, kept: real journey times, where buses lose time, and how reliable each route is, published for anyone to check.

- Each minute the live feed is saved, and each bus is matched to the timetabled journey it is running.
- Journey times between any two stops, by day and time of day, with the slow end shown as well as the usual.
- A delay map of where buses lose time against the timetable; a stretch is only coloured once it has enough journeys behind it.
- Gaps in the record are listed, not hidden: none so far.

Beyond the baseline

ABOD, the Department's free analytics service, is for officers with an invitation. This is for everyone: the same kind of evidence, plus passenger tools, under an open licence.

- Anyone can open it: no login, no invitation. Councillors, passengers and journalists see the same figures.
- It joins the evidence to the passenger side: live times for every operator, every operator's ticket zones, and the cheapest ticket across them.
- ABOD matches a bus to its journey by the operator's journey reference and skips it when that does not match the timetable. This site tries three ways, reads the trip feed as well as the location feed, and names 92% of tracked journeys by the operator's own feed.
- ABOD's code can be read on GitHub, but its licence lets only KPMG firms reuse it. This site's code is MIT-licensed: anyone may copy it.

Sources: Analyse Bus Open Data (RTIG); ABOD's matching method (OTP Matching); ABOD's licence.

Public money, public return

The data is paid for by the public. The return should be public too: information and evidence anyone can use, for under £20 a year more.

- Every figure on this site is built on that data, on free hosting, for under £20 a year: the cost of the web address.

Sources: PublicTechnology: DfT to spend £37m on real-time bus data service (4 September 2023); ITS UK: Department for Transport chooses Kainos to run the Bus Open Data Service (17 November 2025).

Step 6 of 8 · Recorded and replayed

How far to trust it

Every figure says what it was divided by, how it was made, and what would make it wrong.

- Live estimates are within two minutes of when the bus left 71% of the time, against 47% for the timetable alone, and we publish how often we are wrong.
- Good to about a minute, not a second; fewer than 10 journeys over 5 days shows "too few", never a number.
- 92% of 110,005 tracked journeys are matched to their journey by the operator's own feed.
- We are timing buses by hand to check our stop times; the result will be published here.
- A bus we did not see is "missing", never "cancelled": its tracker may simply have been off.

Sources: Live-estimate accuracy: a replay of 20 recorded days (16 October 2026).

What one coast shows

If one volunteer can do this for one coast, an authority or a partner can do it for a region. The template is coming; the code is already open.

- The data is national; only the questions are local.
- Open by default: MIT-licensed code, CC BY words and data, and every day's evidence archived in public.
- A template for other regions is on the way, and a company that wants to develop this further would have full support.

Step 8 of 8 · Get in touch

Let's build it together

The code is open and the data is public. Operators: check our figures. Councils: plan the coast as one corridor. Technology firms and other regions: help turn this into a template.

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The code on GitHub

The tour on your phone